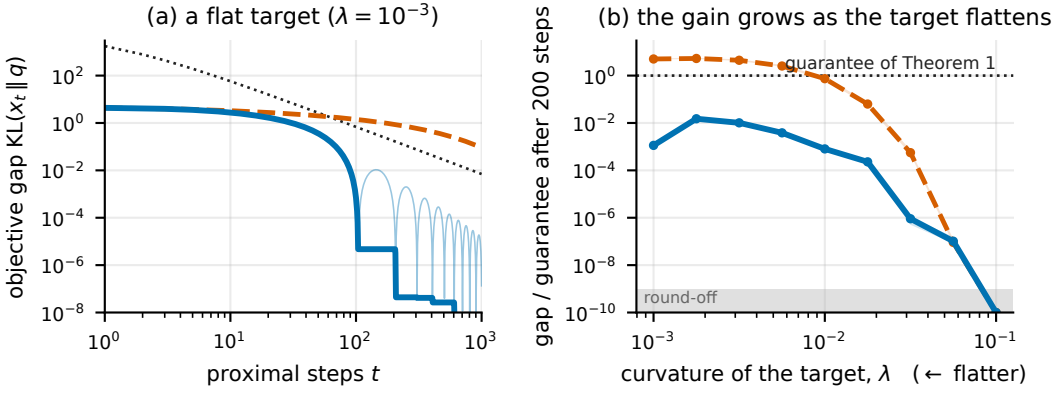
(a) a flat target ($\lambda = 10^{-3}$)
objective gap $\mathrm{KL}(x_t \,\|\, q)$
10^{2}
10^{0}
10^{-2}
10^{-4}
10^{-6}
10^{-8}
10^{0}
10^{1}
10^{2}
10^{3}
proximal steps t
(b) the gain grows as the target flattens
gap / guarantee after 200 steps
guarantee of Theorem 1
round-off
10^{0}
10^{-2}
10^{-4}
10^{-6}
10^{-8}
10^{-10}
10^{-3}
10^{-2}
10^{-1}
curvature of the target, λ (← flatter)
accelerated (Alg. 1), best so far
accelerated, every iterate
JKO
guarantee of Theorem 1